The Guessing Game



Domain:

Oral social interaction

Benchmark:

Ask and answer simple questions about familiar topics and everyday situations

Description:

In this task, the teacher passes around a bag or bowl that contains topic cards. Each pupil takes a card from the bag or bowl. He or she then describes the item or concept in English without saying the word on the card. The pupil continues describing the item or concept until someone in the class can guess what it is.

Rationale for choice of topic:

Children are familiar with the genre of guessing games such as charades. The game provides an enjoyable, authentic setting for spontaneous oral interaction. The task is designed to draw on previously learned vocabulary.

Suggestions for implementation (prior to and/or during):

Have a class discussion about how to describe objects and concepts without naming them. Introduce the class to the concept of clues and discuss what makes an effective clue. Have the class practice giving descriptions and guessing what is being described. You may tape the game to make evaluation easier.

Note: It is very important to teach pupils how to use a checklist before they are given this performance task.

Suggested time allotment:

One lesson

Prerequisites:

- Ability to describe items and concepts (adjectives)
- Knowledge of basic vocabulary of common objects and concepts (nouns)



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For the teacher:

Photocopy this page (enlarging it if possible). Cut out the following cards. Color in the oval on cards that refer to colors. Mix up the cards in a bag or bowl. Have each pupil, in turn, choose one card. While passing around the cards, remind pupils not to tell anyone what item or concept appears on their card. Have each pupil describe the item or concept in English to the class without using the word itself.

purple	blue	green	black	red	orange	brown
yellow	white	apple	banana	bread	falafel	ice-cream
burger	spaghetti	cucumber	dogs	cats	cows	horses
turtles	birds	dinosaurs	snakes	bugs	fish	trees
flowers	clouds	snow	telephone	bicycle	books	kites
balls	hats	sun	winter	spring	fall	morning
night	wind	jeans	shoes	cars	movies	birthdays

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Points	Performance
5	♦ Some degree of fluency, with few hesitations ♦ Only English was used ♦ Speech was clear and easy to understand ♦ Vocabulary was varied and relevant
4	
3	♦ Speech was hesitant ♦ English was used most of the time ♦ Speech was somewhat clear and understandable ♦ Vocabulary was basic and partly relevant
2	
1	♦ Found it difficult to speak at all ♦ First language was used often ♦ Speech was unclear and difficult to understand ♦ Vocabulary was limited and irrelevant